

IN STYLE AND SUBSTANCE, BUSH AND OBAMA ARE A STUDY IN CONTRASTS



ominous military dimension. Long time watcher of India and Pakistan, Michael Krepon of the Stimson Center, says, "Obama deeply respects India and there will be no unpleasant surprises—he will be good for India."

WILL THE NUKE DEAL SURVIVE OBAMA?

The Indo-US nuclear deal has become the symbol of the makeover in relations between the two countries. But with the Bush administration out and the Democrats now controlling both the presidency and the US Congress, will there be a slowdown in its implementation? After all many of the Democrats, including Obama, were lukewarm to it and had tried to move killer amendments. Though the deal did get bipartisan support, there was a clear Republican stamp to it.

Yet there is all round optimism that the change in the administration would not affect the deal. Sen says, "It's a done deal and will not be undone." Agreeing with him, Teresita Schaffer, director of the South Asia Programme at the Centre for Strategic and International Studies in DC, points out, "Obama publicly supported the deal during the campaign. He made it clear that he wanted to in-

tween the two countries. The civilian nuclear deal, which ended India's pariah status and allowed it to conduct nuclear trade with other countries including the US, was a shot that was heard across the globe signalling the firming up of relations between the world's largest democracy and the globe's greatest one.

In Bush's world of good and evil, India was among the good guys and worthy of his unstinted support. In contrast, Obama is more thoughtful and consultative in his dealings. His agenda, with worrisome foreign policy issues

IN BUSH'S WORLD OF GOOD AND EVIL INDIA WAS A GOOD GUY AND WORTHY OF HIS SUPPORT. BUT OBAMA IS MORE THOUGHTFUL AND CONSULTATIVE.

including pulling US troops out of Iraq and serious domestic concerns like shoring up the economy, is crowded. India is way down his long roll-out list unless its confrontation with Pakistan over the Mumbai attacks begins to take an

herit a done deal and didn't want to bring it to birth. I don't think the change in administration will have much impact on its progress." America's civil nuclear industry is confident of that too. Just last week, the US India Business